

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Truck and Delivery Driver English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Truck drivers, local delivery drivers, and driver helpers.

All cases, names, quantities, schedules, and company arrangements are fictional English practice, not driving, loading, cargo-handling, legal, or safety training. Service terms and duties vary. Follow employer training and applicable requirements; refer vehicle operation, access safety, claims, fees, and regulatory decisions to responsible qualified people. Phone conversations take place while parked, never while driving.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

Open this course on English Ladder

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Confirming the delivery destination

Resolve conflicting location details using names and reference numbers.

02 Checking shipment counts

Report a quantity discrepancy without inventing its cause.

03 Updating an arrival estimate

Give a delay message with an explicit unresolved booking.

04 Describing a delivery exception

Agree factual wording while preserving the receiver's concern.

05 When the recipient cannot receive

Identify what can be arranged within the customer's constraints.

06 Explaining the booked service boundary

Explain a service mismatch and offer a booking review.

07 Matching a return to its collection

Clarify the identity and quantity of goods offered for collection.

08 Closing a route with a clear handoff

Provide enough detail to avoid an unnecessary repeat delivery.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Confirming the delivery destination

Resolve conflicting location details using names and reference numbers.

SITUATION

Shipment 418 names Alder Books at 26 Mill Street, suite 4. The route note says rear annex. The receiver confirms that the annex belongs to suite 6; suite 4 uses the staffed front desk. Dispatch must correct the conflicting note.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

consignee - The person or business named to receive a shipment.

delivery window - The agreed period during which a delivery is expected or accepted.

stop sequence - The planned order of delivery locations on a route.

delivery instruction - A shipment-specific note about where or how receipt is arranged.

Useful word combinations

confirm the receiving address: check the shipment's actual destination

read back the suite number: repeat it for confirmation

check the stop sequence: identify the planned next delivery

clarify the delivery window: establish the agreed arrival period

LESSON 01 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Ask which destination a note identifies

3. Notice the language

An address can identify a building without identifying the consignee. Ask a narrow question and repeat the answer.

The label names ___, while the note says ___.

Which entrance receives deliveries for ___?

So ___ refers to ___, not ___.

Compare this wording: It says the back somewhere.

Clearer: Does the rear-annex note apply to Alder Books in suite 4?

The revised question links the direction to the named recipient.

4. Check the language

1. Driver: The label says suite 4, but your annex is suite 6. Which detail should I ___ with dispatch?

Receiver: The entrance note.

A. confirmation

B. confirm

C. confirmed

D. confirming

2. Receiver: Alder Books receives at the front desk, not the annex.

Driver: So the ___ for this consignee needs correcting.

A. stop sequence

B. arrival time

C. delivery instruction

D. delivery window

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The annex belongs to another tenant

Parked at Mill Street, the driver calls Alder Books about shipment 418.

01 • Driver: I have shipment four eighteen for Alder Books, suite four, at twenty-six Mill Street.

02 • Receiver: That's our address, but please tell me which entrance your delivery instruction mentions.

03 • Driver: It says rear annex. Does that describe your receiving entrance or another tenant's?

04 • Receiver: The annex serves suite six. Our deliveries come to the staffed front desk.

05 • Driver: Thanks. Is the front desk identified as Alder Books rather than the building's general reception?

06 • Receiver: Yes, the Alder Books sign is beside it. I'll be there to receive.

07 • Driver: I'll ask dispatch to correct that entrance note specifically for your suite today.

08 • Receiver: Please keep suite six separate; they still need their deliveries at the annex.

09 • Driver: Understood. Suite four, Alder Books, staffed front desk; the annex instruction doesn't apply.

10 • Receiver: That's correct. Use shipment four eighteen when you speak to our front desk.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Two businesses called Pine

A driver checks an ambiguous consignee name with a shipping clerk before departure.

01 • Driver: My next stop says Pine, but two businesses on Station Road use that name.

02 • Shipping clerk: The consignee should be Pine Fabrics. What street number appears on your label?

03 • Driver: It shows eighty-two. The route summary only says Pine and leaves out the number.

04 • Shipping clerk: Pine Cycles is at twenty-eight; Pine Fabrics is at eighty-two, beside the library.

05 • Driver: Could you confirm the shipment reference before I connect that address to this stop?

06 • Shipping clerk: Yes, it's shipment six seventy, four cartons addressed to Pine Fabrics receiving.

07 • Driver: That matches my label. I'll use the full business name in my delivery call.

08 • Shipping clerk: Please do. Their receiving window is ten to twelve, unlike the cycle shop's.

09 • Driver: So eight two Station Road, Pine Fabrics, four cartons, between ten and twelve.

10 • Shipping clerk: Exactly. I'll expand the shortened consignee name in the route summary now.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The gate note is for yesterday

A parked driver checks a delivery instruction with a site receptionist.

01 • Driver: My delivery instruction says contact Lee at the west gate for today's paper order.

02 • Receptionist: Lee covered receiving yesterday. Today Rosa is the receiving contact at the east office.

03 • Driver: Has the receiving location changed, or just the person answering the delivery call?

04 • Receptionist: Both changed for this order. The west gate note was temporary for yesterday.

05 • Driver: I need dispatch to verify the revised instruction before treating that as my destination.

06 • Receptionist: Certainly. Give them order nine twelve; our booking confirmation names Rosa and the east office.

07 • Driver: Do today's delivery hours remain the same as the original ten-to-eleven window?

08 • Receptionist: Yes. That window is unchanged, and Rosa is expecting your call within it.

09 • Driver: I'll report a contact and location correction, with no change to the booked window.

10 • Receptionist: That describes it accurately. I'll have Rosa available to confirm the order details.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Confirming the delivery destination

Shipment 418 names Alder Books at 26 Mill Street, suite 4. The route note says rear annex. The receiver confirms that the annex belongs to suite 6; suite 4 uses the staffed front desk. Dispatch must correct the conflicting note.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Receiver: suite 4 uses the staffed front desk; the annex serves suite 6.

Second round: Dispatch asks whether all deliveries use the front desk. Limit the correction to Alder Books.

Scenario 2 | A building number without a unit

Label: 54 Cedar Court, Oak Tutors, three cartons. Reception serves units A and B; Oak Tutors is in B. Dispatch has no unit recorded.

Role A: Driver: ask for the full receiving identity and repeat it.

Role B: Receptionist: Oak Tutors is unit B; unit A is a different company.

Possible opening: Does this address identify your company or just the building?

Success checks

- Obtain unit B explicitly.
- Keep the three-carton shipment linked to Oak Tutors.
- Request the missing unit correction.

Add a complication: Reception says 'the second one' instead of naming the unit.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Checking shipment counts

Report a quantity discrepancy without inventing its cause.

SITUATION

At Finch Office Supplies, the bill of lading lists twelve cartons. Driver and receiver count eleven. Contents have not been checked; dispatch has no location for the twelfth carton.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

bill of lading - A transport document identifying the shipment, parties, and goods; its legal effect depends on the shipment and applicable rules.

piece count - The number of separately counted packages or handling units, with the unit stated.

short shipment - A delivery containing fewer goods than the agreed or documented quantity.

packing list - An itemized description of the contents packed for an order.

Useful word combinations

reconcile the piece count: compare counted units with the document

count by carton: state cartons rather than individual products

note a shortage: record the confirmed missing quantity

match the shipment reference: ensure documents concern the same load

LESSON 02 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

State what was actually counted

3. Notice the language

A carton count and a product count answer different questions. Name the unit and evidence.

The document lists ___ cartons; we counted ___.

That confirms ___, but not ___.

Can we note the difference against ___?

Compare this wording: There are twelve things missing.

Clearer: We counted eleven of the twelve listed cartons; the missing product quantity is unconfirmed.

The correction prevents a carton difference from becoming an invented product shortage.

4. Check the language

1. Receiver: Did you count the pens inside?

Driver: No. Eleven is the ___ count, not the pen count.

A. inner-pack

B. pallet

C. individual-item

D. carton

2. Dispatcher: Can you locate the missing carton or give a replacement date?

Driver: No. What we have confirmed is ___.

A. a one-carton difference against the document

B. the missing carton's current depot

C. the number of pens inside it

D. the date its replacement will arrive

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Eleven cartons at Finch

The driver and receiver compare the physical delivery with its bill of lading.

01 • Driver: The bill of lading lists twelve cartons for Finch, but I count eleven here.

02 • Receiver: I get eleven too. Does that mean twelve boxes of pens are missing inside?

03 • Driver: Not necessarily. We've counted outer cartons, and we haven't checked their individual contents.

04 • Receiver: Then the short shipment is one carton, with the product quantity still unknown?

05 • Driver: Yes. Please compare the shipment reference as well so we're using the matching document.

06 • Receiver: The reference matches. Can you tell me where that last carton is now?

07 • Driver: Dispatch doesn't have its location yet. I'll report the confirmed difference, not guess.

08 • Receiver: I need the receipt to show that we received eleven against twelve listed.

09 • Driver: That wording matches our count. We'll keep any later contents discrepancy separate.

10 • Receiver: Agreed. I'll use eleven cartons received and one carton short for this handover.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Bundles counted as pieces

At a print shop, a driver and receiver clarify the counting unit.

01 • Receiver: Your document says six pieces, but I ordered twenty-four packs of printed menus.

02 • Driver: These are six bundles. Let's compare the packing list before calling the order short.

03 • Receiver: The list says four packs per bundle, with six bundles in this shipment.

04 • Driver: That explains the difference in units: six handling pieces, twenty-four listed packs overall.

05 • Receiver: We haven't opened every bundle, so twenty-four is the listed contents, not our verified count.

06 • Driver: Exactly. I can confirm six bundles here, matching the transport document's piece count.

07 • Receiver: Please use the word bundles when you describe what I am receiving today.

08 • Driver: I will. That avoids making six sound like the total number of menu packs.

09 • Receiver: I'll compare the contents with the packing list separately after this handover.

10 • Driver: Then today's receipt can distinguish the six received bundles from their listed contents.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Two orders on one counter

A driver checks a shop's apparent overdelivery.

01 • Driver: You mentioned an extra carton. Which order reference are you comparing with the delivery?

02 • Shop assistant: My list shows three cartons for order eight forty, but four are on the counter.

03 • Driver: Three carry eight forty. The fourth has eight forty-one and a different department.

04 • Shop assistant: That second department is ours too, but I only have the first order's list.

05 • Driver: Could we keep the references separate rather than mark the first order overdelivered?

06 • Shop assistant: Yes. Our stockroom contact handles eight forty-one and can confirm that carton separately.

07 • Driver: Then for your order, we agree three cartons listed and three cartons received?

08 • Shop assistant: Correct. I won't add the fourth carton to this order's receipt quantity.

09 • Driver: I'll contact the stockroom recipient about the separate order before completing its handover.

10 • Shop assistant: Thanks. The count now makes sense without changing either order's expected quantity.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Checking shipment counts

At Finch Office Supplies, the bill of lading lists twelve cartons. Driver and receiver count eleven. Contents have not been checked; dispatch has no location for the twelfth carton.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Receiver: confirm eleven cartons but not their contents.

Second round: A colleague says one missing carton means twelve missing products. Ask for the packing detail.

Scenario 2 | A pallet count mistaken for a carton count

Shipment P31 lists two pallets containing eighteen cartons in total. Receiver initially reports sixteen cartons missing after seeing '2' on the transport summary.

Role A: Driver: clarify which unit the summary counts.

Role B: Receiver: confirm two pallets are present; carton contents remain unchecked.

Possible opening: Does that two refer to pallets or cartons?

Success checks

- Distinguish pallets from cartons.
- Confirm only the two visible pallets.
- Leave the carton count explicitly unverified.

Add a complication: Receiver wants the eighteen cartons marked as counted before the contents check.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Updating an arrival estimate

Give a delay message with an explicit unresolved booking.

SITUATION

Driver is parked and calls dispatch at 10:20. Estimated arrival is 11:40; receiver's cutoff is 11:30. No later slot is confirmed. Dispatch can contact receiving and update the driver by 10:40.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

estimated time of arrival - The currently expected arrival time, often shortened to ETA, rather than a guaranteed arrival.

receiving cutoff - The latest time a site accepts a specified delivery under its booking arrangements.

delay notice - A message explaining that planned delivery timing has changed.

revised appointment - A replacement delivery booking agreed after the original booking changes.

Useful word combinations

revise the arrival estimate: give the latest supported timing

miss the receiving cutoff: arrive after the acceptance time

give an update by noon: promise a communication time

request a revised appointment: ask for another confirmed slot

LESSON 03 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Separate arrival, acceptance, and update times

3. Notice the language

A later estimate does not extend a cutoff. Agree the next message time without promising delivery.

Our current estimated arrival is ____.

That falls ____ the receiving cutoff.

Please confirm the booking status by ____.

Compare this wording: We'll be there soon.

Clearer: Our estimate is 11:40; receiving closes at 11:30. A later slot is not confirmed.

The two times explain why dispatch needs to act.

4. Check the language

1. Dispatcher: Is 11:40 within their window?

Driver: No, it is ten minutes ____ the cutoff.

A. within

B. until

C. before

D. after

2. Receiver: Can you promise arrival at noon?

Driver: I can provide an ____, but arrival still depends on conditions.

A. estimate

B. appointment confirmation

C. delivery receipt

D. dispatch confirmation

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Ten minutes beyond the cutoff

A parked driver calls dispatch at 10:20 about stop five.

01 • Driver: Stop five's estimated time of arrival is eleven forty, after their eleven thirty cutoff.

02 • Dispatcher: Thanks for calling while parked. Have they offered a later receiving appointment today?

03 • Driver: Not yet. The original delivery window no longer fits the estimate I have.

04 • Dispatcher: I can call receiving now and give you a booking update by ten forty.

05 • Driver: Please distinguish their acceptance decision from my arrival estimate when you speak to them.

06 • Dispatcher: Certainly. I won't say the later arrival automatically means they will unload us.

07 • Driver: If they only offer tomorrow, I'll need you to review the rest of this route.

08 • Dispatcher: I'll include that in the update. For now, no replacement appointment is confirmed.

09 • Driver: So ten forty is our next communication time, not a revised delivery promise.

10 • Dispatcher: Correct. I'll report the actual offer or explain that we're still waiting.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Early does not mean booked

A parked driver discusses an early arrival with a receiver.

01 • Driver: I'm earlier than expected, but my delivery appointment is still scheduled for two thirty.

02 • Receiver: Our receiving team is handling another booking. We can't confirm earlier acceptance today.

03 • Driver: Understood. Should I describe my status to dispatch as arrived, awaiting the booked window?

04 • Receiver: Yes, although check-in also needs confirmation from the receiving desk, not just this call.

05 • Driver: Thanks for distinguishing those. I'm at the site, but receiving hasn't checked me in.

06 • Receiver: Exactly. Your appointment has not moved simply because your journey took less time.

07 • Driver: I'll tell dispatch the original two-thirty appointment remains in place until receiving confirms otherwise.

08 • Receiver: That will prevent them from telling the next customer you've already finished here.

09 • Driver: Please let the receiving desk know I'm asking about status, not demanding immediate service.

10 • Receiver: I can pass that on. They will confirm your check-in and any available change.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A range instead of a sharp promise

A driver calls a customer from a parked vehicle about an uncertain arrival.

01 • Driver: The latest estimate is between one fifteen and one forty-five for your delivery.

02 • Customer: I heard one fifteen earlier and arranged for someone to arrive at exactly then.

03 • Driver: I'm sorry; I gave the lower end as though it were the whole estimate.

04 • Customer: Does that mean you're now promising one forty-five instead, or is that uncertain too?

05 • Driver: That's still an estimate, not a guaranteed latest arrival. Dispatch is tracking the delay.

06 • Customer: I need to tell my colleague what we can actually rely on today.

07 • Driver: You can tell them the current estimated range and that dispatch will update you at noon.

08 • Customer: All right. Please make sure noon refers to the update, not the delivery.

09 • Driver: It does. I'll ask dispatch to use the full range in that message.

10 • Customer: Thank you. I'll pass along the range instead of another exact arrival promise.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Updating an arrival estimate

Driver is parked and calls dispatch at 10:20. Estimated arrival is 11:40; receiver's cutoff is 11:30. No later slot is confirmed. Dispatch can contact receiving and update the driver by 10:40.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Dispatcher: receiving may offer another slot; promise a booking update by 10:40 only.

Second round: The receiver offers tomorrow at nine. Explain that dispatch still needs to confirm the revised plan.

Scenario 2 | An event delivery with an earlier cutoff

A venue's event starts at 18:00, but receiving closes at 16:00. Current arrival estimate is 16:20. Dispatch can request a new arrangement but none exists.

Role A: Driver: explain why the event time is not the receiving deadline.

Role B: Venue assistant: the event team cannot approve delivery exceptions; receiving can.

Possible opening: Does six o'clock refer to the event or the last delivery?

Success checks

- State the 16:00 receiving cutoff.
- Keep venue opening separate from goods acceptance.
- Ask receiving for a confirmed alternative.

Add a complication: Someone suggests calling 16:20 'before closing' because the venue stays open.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Describing a delivery exception

Agree factual wording while preserving the receiver's concern.

SITUATION

At Grove Studio, one carton has a crushed lower corner. Contents remain unopened. Receiver wants the receipt to say 'broken equipment caused by driver.' Driver can record visible condition, not establish unseen damage or fault.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

visible damage - Damage observable on the outside of a shipment during the check.

exception note - A record of a specific irregularity noticed during delivery.

delivery receipt - A record acknowledging delivery and any recorded qualifications about it.

concealed damage - Damage to contents that is not apparent from the outside at receipt.

Useful word combinations

describe the outer carton: report packaging condition

record an exception: attach a factual delivery qualification

avoid assigning blame: separate observation from cause

check the receipt wording: ensure it matches the observed issue

LESSON 04 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Describe damage without diagnosing it

3. Notice the language

Packaging damage, possible product damage, and responsibility are separate claims.

The visible condition is ____.

We haven't established whether ____.

The note can say ____ without implying ____.

Compare this wording: The machine is ruined.

Clearer: The carton has a crushed lower corner; the contents have not been inspected.

The statement is specific without claiming unseen damage.

4. Check the language

1. Receiver: Have we checked the equipment inside?

Driver: No; the contents are ____.

A. undamaged

B. uninspected

C. damaged

D. inspected

2. Receiver: Does the crushed corner tell us who caused it?

Driver: No. What it directly shows is ____.

A. who last handled the carton

B. that the equipment cannot function

C. the visible packaging condition

D. when the damage occurred

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A crushed corner, not a proven cause

At Grove Studio, a driver discusses an exception note with the receiver.

01 • Receiver: This corner is crushed. I want the receipt to say your driver broke the equipment.

02 • Driver: I can record the crushed lower corner, but we haven't inspected the equipment inside.

03 • Receiver: I don't want a plain signature to make it seem I noticed no problem.

04 • Driver: Understood. The exception note should preserve the visible issue, not erase your concern.

05 • Receiver: Would 'one carton with a crushed lower corner, contents not inspected' describe it clearly?

06 • Driver: Yes. That matches what we can observe without deciding when the damage happened.

07 • Receiver: And if we find damage inside later, does this note settle the claim?

08 • Driver: No. The claims team reviews that separately; I can't promise the outcome today.

09 • Receiver: Then please keep the shipment reference connected to this particular carton and note.

10 • Driver: Agreed. The receipt will identify the observed condition and the uninspected contents.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Wet packaging without a product conclusion

A receiver and driver discuss a damp patch on a stationery carton.

- 01 • Driver:** There is a damp patch on the outer carton beside the shipping label.
- 02 • Receiver:** I see it. Can you confirm the notebooks inside have been damaged by rain?
- 03 • Driver:** I can't confirm either the contents or the cause from that patch alone.
- 04 • Receiver:** Then let's say damp outer packaging rather than wet notebooks throughout the box.
- 05 • Driver:** That is more precise. Shall we identify the affected carton as number three?
- 06 • Receiver:** Yes, three of five. The other four don't show the same visible patch.
- 07 • Driver:** I'll record that distinction so the note doesn't describe every carton as affected.
- 08 • Receiver:** Please also note that we haven't checked the inside during this receipt discussion.
- 09 • Driver:** I can include that. Further findings can be reported against the same shipment reference.
- 10 • Receiver:** That gives our receiving team a clear starting point without claiming an inspection happened.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The wrong color on the exception note

A driver corrects a description before the receiver confirms it.

01 • Receiver: The draft exception note says the blue case is scratched, but the case is gray.

02 • Driver: You're right; I copied the color from another line. Which description matches this item?

03 • Receiver: It's the gray display case, item nineteen, with a scratch on its outer panel.

04 • Driver: I'll correct the color and item reference while keeping the actual observed condition.

05 • Receiver: Please don't call it broken. We haven't tested it or checked its operation.

06 • Driver: Agreed. A scratch on the panel doesn't establish whether the case functions properly.

07 • Receiver: Can you read the revised description so I can check the wording now?

08 • Driver: Gray display case, item nineteen: visible scratch on outer panel; operation not checked.

09 • Receiver: That is accurate. It identifies this item without attaching the wrong color or conclusion.

10 • Driver: Thank you for catching it before confirmation. This revised note is the one we'll use.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Describing a delivery exception

At Grove Studio, one carton has a crushed lower corner. Contents remain unopened. Receiver wants the receipt to say 'broken equipment caused by driver.' Driver can record visible condition, not establish unseen damage or fault.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Receiver: your concern must be recorded; you have not opened the carton.

Second round: The customer asks whether the note guarantees compensation. Separate a record from a claim decision.

Scenario 2 | A torn label and an intact carton

Carton 6 has a torn address label but no visible carton damage. Receiver fears the order reference may be misread; matching paperwork shows K88.

Role A: Driver: distinguish label condition from package damage.

Role B: Receiver: request a reference check, not a product-damage claim.

Possible opening: Is the damage to the label, the carton, or both?

Success checks

- Describe the torn label only.
- Confirm K88 using matching paperwork.
- Correct the unsupported contents claim.

Add a complication: A colleague calls it 'damaged contents' in a verbal summary.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

When the recipient cannot receive

Identify what can be arranged within the customer's constraints.

SITUATION

At 14:10, driver is outside Marlow Design's closed receiving office. Listed contact answers and can return at 15:00. Driver cannot commit to waiting; dispatch can review redelivery, while collection availability is unknown.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

delivery attempt - A visit made to complete delivery, whether or not goods are handed over.

recipient unavailable - A status indicating that an appropriate person could not be reached to receive a shipment.

redelivery - Another delivery visit arranged after an earlier visit did not complete delivery.

collection point - A designated location where an eligible recipient can collect a shipment.

Useful word combinations

record the attempted delivery: state the visit and outcome

reach the named contact: try the listed recipient

arrange a redelivery: obtain another booking

confirm collection availability: verify when and where collection is possible

LESSON 05 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Offer options without inventing availability

3. Notice the language

An attempted delivery is not completed delivery. Separate confirmed options from possibilities.

I reached ___ at ___, but ___.

You could request ___; availability depends on ___.

Please wait for confirmation before ___.

Compare this wording: I'll leave it for you somehow.

Clearer: Dispatch can review redelivery; collection is not yet confirmed.

The response offers a concrete request without implying an unattended handover.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: Does 'attempted' mean you handed it over?

Driver: No. It records the ___, not a completed handover.

- A. handover
- B. collection
- C. acceptance
- D. visit

2. Customer: Should I travel to the depot now?

Driver: Collection is possible only ___ the depot confirms availability.

- A. once
- B. although
- C. despite
- D. unless

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A closed office at Marlow

Parked outside Marlow Design at 14:10, the driver calls the listed contact.

01 • Driver: I'm outside your receiving office at two ten, but it appears closed and nobody answered.

02 • Customer: I'm away until three. Can you wait there and deliver when I return?

03 • Driver: I can't confirm that this route can wait. Dispatch would need to review the timing.

04 • Customer: Could I collect the cartons at your depot instead after my meeting finishes?

05 • Driver: Possibly, but collection availability and the location need confirmation before you make that journey.

06 • Customer: Then please ask about collection first. Redelivery tomorrow would be my second choice.

07 • Driver: I'll pass on those preferences. Today's status remains recipient unavailable, not delivery completed.

08 • Customer: That is fair. Please don't say I refused it; I still want the order.

09 • Driver: I'll record the visit and your request without describing your absence as refusal.

10 • Customer: Thank you. I'll wait for dispatch to confirm an option before traveling anywhere.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The person answering cannot receive

A delivery driver checks who can accept a shipment at a shared office.

01 • Driver: I have a signed-receipt delivery for Northline Research. Are you their receiving contact?

02 • Receptionist: I answer the building's phone, but I can't accept packages for that company.

03 • Driver: Thanks. Is Dana, the consignee's named receiving contact, available to speak with me now?

04 • Receptionist: Dana is in a meeting. I can send a message asking them to call you.

05 • Driver: Please do. I won't treat speaking to building reception as a completed delivery.

06 • Receptionist: Would you like me to say you're waiting for an eligible recipient to respond?

07 • Driver: Yes. Dispatch can review the next step if we can't reach Dana during this visit.

08 • Receptionist: I've sent the message with your shipment reference and the time of your call.

09 • Driver: I'll tell dispatch the building answered, but the consignee's receipt is still unconfirmed.

10 • Receptionist: That wording reflects my role accurately. I haven't agreed to receive the shipment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A redelivery request with no slot yet

A parked driver explains an exception update to a customer.

01 • Customer: The message says redelivery requested. Does that mean tomorrow morning is already booked?

02 • Driver: No. It means your request reached dispatch, but they haven't confirmed a time window.

03 • Customer: I need to decide whether to ask someone to be here before lunch.

04 • Driver: Please wait for the booking confirmation rather than arranging coverage around an unconfirmed morning slot.

05 • Customer: Can you make sure they know afternoons are difficult because our office closes early?

06 • Driver: Yes. What is the latest time your receiving office can accept this particular shipment?

07 • Customer: Two thirty. The rest of the building stays open, but our team leaves then.

08 • Driver: I'll relay that two-thirty cutoff with your preference for morning redelivery.

09 • Customer: Then the request includes my constraint, but it still doesn't promise tomorrow morning.

10 • Driver: Exactly. Dispatch's confirmation should give the actual date and window when the booking is settled.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | When the recipient cannot receive

At 14:10, driver is outside Marlow Design's closed receiving office. Listed contact answers and can return at 15:00. Driver cannot commit to waiting; dispatch can review redelivery, while collection availability is unknown.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: you can return at three but do not know the depot's address or hours.

Second round: The customer prefers collection. Confirm the preference without inventing a collection appointment.

Scenario 2 | A recipient returns after the attempt

A delivery attempt occurred at 11:05. At 11:20 the customer calls back. The route has moved on; a same-day return has not been reviewed.

Role A: Driver: acknowledge the callback and request a dispatch decision.

Role B: Customer: you are available until 13:00 and tomorrow after 10:00.

Possible opening: I'm back now; does that automatically put me next on your route?

Success checks

- Confirm the availability periods.
- Do not promise a route change.
- Explain the difference between request and confirmation.

Add a complication: The customer interprets 'request sent' as 'driver returning.'

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Explaining the booked service boundary

Explain a service mismatch and offer a booking review.

SITUATION

A household delivery is booked curbside. Customer requests upstairs placement. Driver cannot add inside service; dispatch can review an upgrade or rearrangement. No price or timing is known.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

curbside delivery - A delivery service with handover at the agreed curbside location, as defined by the booking.

inside delivery - A booked service including movement to a specified interior location within stated conditions.

access restriction - A site condition or rule limiting where or when delivery can take place.

service level - The delivery features and limits included in a particular booking.

Useful word combinations

check the booked service level: verify what is included

identify an access restriction: explain a limiting site condition

request a service change: ask for a different delivery service

agree the handover point: confirm the permitted receipt location

LESSON 06 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Decline an unbooked extra courteously

3. Notice the language

State the service boundary without judging the customer. An upgrade request is not confirmation.

The booked service includes ___, but not ___.

I can't add ___ at this stop.

Dispatch can review ___ before you decide.

Compare this wording: That's not my problem.

Clearer: The booking is curbside; I'll ask dispatch to review your request for upstairs placement.

The response identifies the mismatch and a useful contact.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: So inside delivery is already included?

Driver: No, it would be a ___ to the current booking.

A. receipt

B. completion

C. confirmation

D. change

2. Dispatcher: Is the requested upgrade confirmed?

Driver: It is ___ review; no revised service has been booked.

A. pending

B. following

C. beyond

D. without

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The upstairs request

A driver and customer compare curbside service with the customer's expectation.

01 • Customer: I need these cartons upstairs. The order page said delivery, so I assumed inside.

02 • Driver: Your booked service level is curbside delivery; upstairs placement isn't included in that service.

03 • Customer: Is that something you can add now if I pay the difference directly?

04 • Driver: I can't add it here. Dispatch can review an inside-delivery request through the booking team.

05 • Customer: Will that mean another day, or can somebody come this afternoon instead?

06 • Driver: I don't have confirmed availability or a price. Those details need checking before you decide.

07 • Customer: Please ask about the upstairs option; curbside isn't what I thought I had arranged.

08 • Driver: I'll explain that mismatch and request a review rather than promise an immediate upgrade.

09 • Customer: Also tell them the destination is the second floor, so the request is clear.

10 • Driver: I will. Your requested location and the current service level will both be stated.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Receiving moved behind a restricted entrance

A parked driver speaks with a site contact about a new access condition.

01 • Driver: The delivery note names the loading entrance, but today's notice shows an access restriction.

02 • Site contact: That entrance is unavailable today. Could you use the visitor entrance for this shipment?

03 • Driver: I need dispatch and your receiving team to review a suitable handover point first.

04 • Site contact: I can connect you with receiving; I only coordinate visitor appointments at this building.

05 • Driver: That would help. I shouldn't treat your visitor instructions as a goods-delivery approval.

06 • Site contact: Agreed. The receiving contact is Morgan, and their desk is staffed until four.

07 • Driver: I'll explain the restricted entrance and ask Morgan which delivery arrangement can be confirmed.

08 • Site contact: Please mention that the original loading entrance is unavailable today, not permanently closed.

09 • Driver: I'll keep the timing specific and leave the alternative location unconfirmed until that discussion.

10 • Site contact: Good. I'll connect Morgan now so the people responsible can resolve the delivery arrangement.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A lobby is not every interior room

A driver clarifies the booked handover location at an office.

01 • Driver: The booking specifies inside delivery to the ground-floor lobby. Is that still your receiving point?

02 • Customer: We hoped you could take the cartons into the archive room along the corridor.

03 • Driver: That room isn't named in this booking. I'll need the service team to review the change.

04 • Customer: But it is still indoors. Doesn't inside delivery cover every room in the building?

05 • Driver: Not necessarily. This booking identifies the lobby specifically, so I can't expand that description myself.

06 • Customer: Please check, then. The archive staff expected the cartons to arrive at their desk.

07 • Driver: I'll explain their expectation and the location currently included, without promising the added movement.

08 • Customer: Can you also say we are asking about today's delivery, not future orders?

09 • Driver: Yes, I'll link the request to this shipment and today's agreed service details.

10 • Customer: That's helpful. We'll wait for the service team's answer before assuming the archive is included.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Explaining the booked service boundary

A household delivery is booked curbside. Customer requests upstairs placement. Driver cannot add inside service; dispatch can review an upgrade or rearrangement. No price or timing is known.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: you expected upstairs placement and need the discrepancy explained.

Second round: The customer offers informal cash. Keep the request within the company's booking review without inventing a fee.

Scenario 2 | A requested time outside the booking

A business booked weekday delivery, but a customer asks the driver for Sunday service. Dispatch reviews weekend options; price and availability are unknown.

Role A: Driver: explain the current service and relay the request.

Role B: Customer: Sunday is preferred; Tuesday afternoon also works.

Possible opening: Does my weekday booking include a Sunday visit?

Success checks

- State the weekday booking.
- Give both customer preferences to dispatch.
- Avoid an invented Sunday price or promise.

Add a complication: Customer thinks a driver's willingness establishes company availability.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Matching a return to its collection

Clarify the identity and quantity of goods offered for collection.

SITUATION

Return R62 lists two printer cartons. Customer presents them and a third carton of cables without a matching reference. Dispatch can query the additional carton; the original two are identifiable.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

return authorization - Approval identifying goods accepted for return under a business's return arrangements.

collection reference - The identifier matching a pickup booking with the goods being collected.

refused delivery - A delivery that the recipient explicitly declines to accept.

return label - A label identifying the destination and reference for goods sent back.

Useful word combinations

match the return reference: connect goods with their approval

distinguish refusal from absence: report why handover failed

confirm the collection quantity: agree the booked units

query an extra carton: check an unlisted package

LESSON 07 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Keep an extra return separate

3. Notice the language

Wanting to return an item does not automatically match it to a collection booking.

This reference covers ___, not ___.

Does the extra carton have ___?

I'll describe it as an additional request until ___.

Compare this wording: All three must be the same return.

Clearer: Two cartons match R62; the cable carton needs its own booking check.

The distinction preserves the confirmed collection and identifies the unresolved extra.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: Are all three cartons listed?

Driver: Two match R62; the third is an ___ request.

- A. identical
- B. original
- C. completed
- D. additional

2. Dispatcher: Did the receiver refuse the delivery?

Driver: No, nobody was there; the recipient was ___.

- A. unavailable
- B. unwilling
- C. uncertain
- D. unprepared

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A third carton beside R62

A driver checks a return collection with a customer.

01 • Driver: Collection R62 lists two printer cartons. I can match these two to that reference.

02 • Customer: The third carton holds cables from the same purchase. I'd like those returned too.

03 • Driver: Do the cables have a separate return authorization or a matching collection reference?

04 • Customer: I only have the printer return message. I thought the purchase reference covered everything.

05 • Driver: A purchase reference and a return collection don't necessarily include the same items.

06 • Customer: Then please ask dispatch whether the cable carton can be added to today's collection.

07 • Driver: I can query it separately. Until confirmed, it remains an additional request, not part of R62.

08 • Customer: That makes sense. Please don't describe all three as printers in your collection record.

09 • Driver: I won't. The two printer cartons match; the cable carton still needs a booking decision.

10 • Customer: Thank you. I'll look for the cable authorization while dispatch checks that separate request.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Refusal because of a reported duplicate

A driver speaks with a receiver who declines a shipment.

01 • Driver: You're declining order seven sixty. Could you explain the reason for the delivery record?

02 • Receiver: Our office believes it's a duplicate. We received what looks like this order yesterday.

03 • Driver: Have you confirmed the two order references match, or is that still being checked?

04 • Receiver: It's still being checked. I can report our concern, but I can't prove duplication yet.

05 • Driver: I'll record refused delivery, with your reported reason, rather than confirmed duplicate order.

06 • Receiver: Please include that I declined it, not that nobody was here to receive it.

07 • Driver: Certainly. Customer service can compare the references and discuss the order with your buyer.

08 • Receiver: Can you promise that refusing this one will automatically cancel the invoice as well?

09 • Driver: I can't decide that. Delivery status and billing decisions need separate review by customer service.

10 • Receiver: Understood. Record today's refusal and the reason as reported, with the billing question outstanding.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The label points to an old return

A driver checks a collection label before matching it to the booking.

01 • Customer: Here's the return carton. I reused the box, so the label should already be there.

02 • Driver: The visible return label shows R19, but today's collection booking is for R91.

03 • Customer: Those numbers look similar. Is the label perhaps from my previous return last month?

04 • Driver: That could explain it, but we need to match this carton to today's actual authorization.

05 • Customer: My confirmation message says R91 for one lamp carton collected from this address.

06 • Driver: That matches the booking details. The old label still creates a destination-reference discrepancy.

07 • Customer: Please report that specifically, rather than saying I have no return approval at all.

08 • Driver: I will. You have an R91 confirmation; the carton displays a different reference.

09 • Customer: Who can tell us how the correct collection identification should be provided now?

10 • Driver: Dispatch's returns contact can resolve that label question before this carton is accepted for collection.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Matching a return to its collection

Return R62 lists two printer cartons. Customer presents them and a third carton of cables without a matching reference. Dispatch can query the additional carton; the original two are identifiable.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: the printers match R62; you cannot find a cable return authorization.

Second round: The cables came in the same purchase. Explain why that does not prove they share the collection reference.

Scenario 2 | One collection split between two contacts

Pickup C44 covers four cartons at Delta Studio. Reception has two; the stockroom has two. Both contacts think the driver is collecting only theirs.

Role A: Driver: establish the total and each location's contribution.

Role B: Receptionist: confirm your two and connect the stockroom contact.

Possible opening: Does four mean here at reception or across the whole collection?

Success checks

- Keep the overall booking at four.
- Separate each contact's confirmed two.
- Do not claim the stockroom handover has occurred.

Add a complication: Reception offers to confirm receipt of all four before the stockroom is checked.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Closing a route with a clear handoff

Provide enough detail to avoid an unnecessary repeat delivery.

SITUATION

Route 12 is ending. Stop 7 was received by Mei at 16:05 but its receipt has not uploaded. Stop 8 was refused because the customer reported a duplicate order. Evening dispatcher Jo will check the receipt and contact customer service about stop 8.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

proof of delivery - A record supporting a delivery event, such as named receipt or other evidence required for that service.

outstanding stop - A scheduled delivery whose outcome still needs completion or clarification.

dispatch log - The dispatch team's record of route events and messages.

follow-up owner - The named person responsible for the next action on an unresolved delivery issue.

Useful word combinations

reconcile the delivery status: compare records with events

name the follow-up owner: identify who takes the next action

flag a missing receipt: separate missing evidence from missing delivery

close the communication loop: obtain acknowledgment of the handoff

LESSON 08 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Hand over evidence and unresolved work separately

3. Notice the language

A missing upload is not automatically a failed delivery. Preserve the event, record status, and next owner.

The delivery occurred at ____; the record is ____.

The customer reported ____; we have not verified ____.

Can you take ____ and confirm ____?

Compare this wording: Two stops failed.

Clearer: Stop 7 was received but its upload is pending; stop 8 was refused.

The handoff distinguishes two different exceptions.

4. Check the language

1. Dispatcher: Was stop 7 physically delivered?

Driver: Yes; only the receipt ____ is pending.

- A. upload
- B. signature
- C. handover
- D. delivery

2. Dispatcher: The customer says it may be a duplicate but hasn't checked.

Driver: I'll record that as an unverified ____, not a confirmed duplicate.

- A. report
- B. resolution
- C. instruction
- D. approval

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Received goods, pending upload

A driver hands route 12 to evening dispatcher Jo.

01 • Driver: Jo, Mei received stop seven at sixteen oh five; the proof of delivery upload is pending.

02 • Dispatcher: I'll take that follow-up. What happened at stop eight, which also shows an exception?

03 • Driver: The customer refused it, saying the order was a duplicate. That reason isn't independently verified.

04 • Dispatcher: So seven concerns missing digital evidence; eight concerns a physical refusal with a reported reason.

05 • Driver: Exactly. Please don't arrange redelivery solely because the proof of delivery hasn't uploaded.

06 • Dispatcher: I'll check its record first and pass stop eight to customer service for review.

07 • Driver: Could you confirm you're taking both items after my route ends this evening?

08 • Dispatcher: Yes, I'm the follow-up owner for the receipt check and the customer-service handoff.

09 • Driver: I'll leave the recipient, time, and refusal details together in the dispatch log.

10 • Dispatcher: I have them. The log now distinguishes received pending upload from refused pending order review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A corrected contact number for tomorrow

A driver hands a confirmed information change to the next dispatcher.

01 • Driver: Tomorrow's Lakeside stop has a corrected receiving number. The old number reaches the sales office.

02 • Dispatcher: Who confirmed the new number, and does the receiving location change as well?

03 • Driver: The named receiver confirmed it today. The address and entrance remain exactly the same.

04 • Dispatcher: I'll update the receiving contact field, not replace every contact number on the account.

05 • Driver: Good. Sales still uses the old number, so deleting it everywhere would create another problem.

06 • Dispatcher: Does the change apply to tomorrow's booking only, or to future receiving calls too?

07 • Driver: The receiver said future receiving calls. I haven't checked any separate after-hours arrangement.

08 • Dispatcher: I'll label the number for receiving and leave after-hours details unchanged pending confirmation.

09 • Driver: Please include that distinction in tomorrow's route handoff so the next driver uses the right field.

10 • Dispatcher: Done. The handoff identifies the new receiving number without implying the sales contact is invalid.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A return that has not reached the depot

A returning driver gives the desk a status update from a parked vehicle.

01 • Dispatcher: Your app says return initiated. Have the two refused cartons already reached our depot?

02 • Driver: No. They remain on my vehicle; initiated records the return instruction, not depot receipt.

03 • Dispatcher: Thanks. Customer service was about to tell the sender that the return was received.

04 • Driver: Please correct that to return in progress. Depot intake still needs to confirm the handover.

05 • Dispatcher: I'll change the message before it goes out. Which original shipment reference applies?

06 • Driver: Shipment five twelve, two cartons refused this afternoon because the recipient reported a wrong order.

07 • Dispatcher: I have that. Is wrong order verified, or should we keep it as the recipient's report?

08 • Driver: Keep it attributed to the recipient. Customer service has not completed its order comparison.

09 • Dispatcher: Then we'll await intake confirmation before reporting the cartons as received back at the depot.

10 • Driver: Exactly. That leaves both the physical return and the order query accurately described.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Closing a route with a clear handoff

Route 12 is ending. Stop 7 was received by Mei at 16:05 but its receipt has not uploaded. Stop 8 was refused because the customer reported a duplicate order. Evening dispatcher Jo will check the receipt and contact customer service about stop 8.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Evening dispatcher Jo: accept the follow-ups and repeat each actual status.

Second round: Another screen labels both stops 'exception.' Explain the different events beneath that label.

Scenario 2 | Two pending items with different owners

Route 4 ends with receipt upload U8 assigned to evening dispatch and a return-label query R7 assigned to returns desk. Neither is resolved.

Role A: Driver: hand over each item to its actual owner.

Role B: Dispatcher: accept U8 but explain that returns desk owns R7; its contact is Imani.

Possible opening: Which of these two follow-ups are you taking personally?

Success checks

- Name evening dispatch for U8.
- Name Imani at returns for R7.
- Request acknowledgment without calling either issue resolved.

Add a complication: Dispatcher says 'I'll pass it on' without identifying the recipient.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Confirming the delivery destination

Editing example: Does the rear-annex note apply to Alder Books in suite 4?

The revised question links the direction to the named recipient.

Check 1: B - confirm

A: A noun cannot follow 'should I' here.

B: Correct. 'Confirm' is the base verb after 'should.'

C: The past form does not fit after 'should.'

D: The modal 'should' takes the base verb.

Check 2: C - delivery instruction

A: The order of stops is not disputed.

B: The arrival time is not disputed.

C: Correct. The incorrect detail concerns the receiving location.

D: No time window has changed.

Model response: Shipment 418 names suite 4, but the route note points to the rear annex. Could you confirm which entrance receives Alder Books deliveries? I need the receiving location for this shipment, not just the building address. I'll ask dispatch to correct the note once we have that distinction clear.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Checking shipment counts

Editing example: We counted eleven of the twelve listed cartons; the missing product quantity is unconfirmed.

The correction prevents a carton difference from becoming an invented product shortage.

Check 1: D - carton

A: The inner packs have not been counted during this handover.

B: The shipment count concerns cartons, not pallets.

C: Individual products inside the cartons were not counted.

D: Correct. Eleven refers to the outer cartons counted.

Check 2: A - a one-carton difference against the document

A: Correct. Twelve listed versus eleven counted confirms this difference.

B: No depot location has been confirmed for the carton.

C: The individual contents have not been verified or counted.

D: No replacement delivery date has been established here.

Model response: The bill of lading lists twelve cartons, and we have counted eleven together. That is a one-carton difference, not a confirmed count of missing individual products. Could we record the carton shortage against this shipment reference? Dispatch will investigate the remaining carton; I don't have its location or a replacement date.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Updating an arrival estimate

Editing example: Our estimate is 11:40; receiving closes at 11:30. A later slot is not confirmed.

The two times explain why dispatch needs to act.

Check 1: D - after

A: 'Within' would mean inside the period.

B: 'Until' expresses duration toward a time.

C: 11:40 is later, not earlier.

D: Correct. 'After' states the time relationship.

Check 2: A - estimate

A: Correct. An estimate communicates expected, not guaranteed, timing.

B: An appointment confirmation establishes a booking, not predicted arrival.

C: A delivery receipt records a handover that already happened.

D: Dispatch confirmation concerns departure, not the expected arrival time.

Model response: I'm parked and calling about stop five. The estimated arrival is now 11:40, ten minutes after the receiver's 11:30 cutoff. A later appointment hasn't been confirmed. Please check whether receiving can offer another slot and update me by 10:40. I can't describe the original window as achievable on the current estimate.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Describing a delivery exception

Editing example: The carton has a crushed lower corner; the contents have not been inspected.

The statement is specific without claiming unseen damage.

Check 1: B - uninspected

A: No inspection supports calling the contents undamaged.

B: Correct. The contents have not yet been inspected.

C: Outer-carton damage does not prove damage inside.

D: Inspected contradicts the receiver's stated lack of checking.

Check 2: C - the visible packaging condition

A: It does not identify the last person who handled it.

B: The uninspected equipment's function has not been established.

C: Correct. The observable fact concerns the carton packaging.

D: The visible condition does not establish when it happened.

Model response: The lower corner of this carton is crushed; that is what we can both see. We haven't inspected the contents, and I can't establish when the damage occurred. Could the exception note describe the crushed corner without stating that the equipment is broken or assigning responsibility? The claim review can consider further evidence.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | When the recipient cannot receive

Editing example: Dispatch can review redelivery; collection is not yet confirmed.

The response offers a concrete request without implying an unattended handover.

Check 1: D - visit

A: A handover would require goods actually changing hands.

B: Collection is a separate arrangement, not this failed visit.

C: Acceptance has not occurred while the recipient is absent.

D: Correct. The visit occurred without a completed handover.

Check 2: A - once

A: Correct. Confirmation must come first.

B: 'Although' introduces contrast, not sequence.

C: 'Despite' does not express the required condition.

D: 'Unless' would reverse the condition.

Model response: I reached your receiving office at 14:10, but no recipient was available. I understand you can return at 15:00; I can't confirm that this route can wait until then. We can ask dispatch about redelivery. Collection may be another option, but its location and availability still need confirmation before you travel.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Explaining the booked service boundary

Editing example: The booking is curbside; I'll ask dispatch to review your request for upstairs placement.

The response identifies the mismatch and a useful contact.

Check 1: D - change

A: A receipt records delivery rather than adds service scope.

B: Completion describes finished service, not a requested upgrade.

C: Confirmation alone would not add the requested inside service.

D: Correct. Upstairs placement would change the currently booked service.

Check 2: A - pending

A: Correct. 'Pending review' means awaiting a decision.

B: 'Following review' puts review earlier.

C: 'Beyond review' implies review no longer applies.

D: 'Without review' misses the waiting status.

Model response: Your booking shows curbside delivery, whereas you need the cartons taken upstairs. That additional service isn't included in the booking I have, and I can't add it here. I can contact dispatch to review an inside-delivery option or rearrangement. We'll need the service details confirmed before promising a location, price, or date.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Matching a return to its collection

Editing example: Two cartons match R62; the cable carton needs its own booking check.

The distinction preserves the confirmed collection and identifies the unresolved extra.

Check 1: D - additional

A: Different contents and no reference prevent that description.

B: It was not in the original quantity.

C: Its collection has not completed.

D: Correct. It adds to the booking.

Check 2: A - unavailable

A: Correct. Absence is described as recipient unavailable.

B: Unwilling implies refusal, but nobody was present to refuse.

C: Uncertain suggests indecision by a person who was present.

D: Unprepared suggests someone was present but not ready.

Model response: Collection R62 covers two printer cartons, and both match the booking. The cable carton has no matching reference, so I need to query it separately. Is there another return authorization for that carton? I can report the additional request, but I can't describe it as included in R62 without confirmation.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Closing a route with a clear handoff

Editing example: Stop 7 was received but its upload is pending; stop 8 was refused.

The handoff distinguishes two different exceptions.

Check 1: A - upload

A: Correct. The receipt's transmission, not the handover, remains pending.

B: No missing-signature issue is established by this account.

C: Mei already received the goods at 16:05.

D: The physical delivery occurred; its digital evidence remains pending.

Check 2: A - report

A: Correct. A report preserves the unverified account without confirming duplication.

B: The order question remains unresolved, not settled.

C: The statement describes a possible issue rather than giving an instruction.

D: The customer expressed a concern, not an approval.

Model response: For route 12, stop 7 was received by Mei at 16:05, but the receipt upload is still pending. Stop 8 was refused; the customer said the order was a duplicate. Jo, please take the receipt follow-up and pass the refusal to customer service. Can you confirm those two items remain distinct in the dispatch log?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases, names, quantities, schedules, and company arrangements are fictional English practice, not driving, loading, cargo-handling, legal, or safety training. Service terms and duties vary. Follow employer training and applicable requirements; refer vehicle operation, access safety, claims, fees, and regulatory decisions to responsible qualified people. Phone conversations take place while parked, never while driving.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

BLS Occupational Outlook Handbook: Heavy and Tractor-Trailer Truck Drivers

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/transportation-and-material-moving/heavy-and-tractor-trailer-truck-drivers.htm>

BLS Occupational Outlook Handbook: Delivery Truck Drivers and Driver/Sales Workers

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/transportation-and-material-moving/delivery-truck-drivers-and-driver-sales-workers.htm>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Truck and Delivery Driver English

Professional audience: Truck drivers, local delivery drivers, and driver helpers

Scope: All cases, names, quantities, schedules, and company arrangements are fictional English practice, not driving, loading, cargo-handling, legal, or safety training. Service terms and duties vary. Follow employer training and applicable requirements; refer vehicle operation, access safety, claims, fees, and regulatory decisions to responsible qualified people. Phone conversations take place while parked, never while driving.

Lesson 01: Confirming the delivery destination

Original fictional case: Shipment 418 names Alder Books at 26 Mill Street, suite 4. The route note says rear annex. The receiver confirms that the annex belongs to suite 6; suite 4 uses the staffed front desk. Dispatch must correct the conflicting note.

Language workshop: Ask which destination a note identifies

Communication goal: Resolve conflicting location details using names and reference numbers.

Language guidance: An address can identify a building without identifying the consignee. Ask a narrow question and repeat the answer.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): The label names ___, while the note says ___. / Which entrance receives deliveries for ___? / So ___ refers to ___, not ___.

Vocabulary: consignee: The person or business named to receive a shipment. / delivery window: The agreed period during which a delivery is expected or accepted. / stop sequence: The planned order of delivery locations on a route. / delivery instruction: A shipment-specific note about where or how receipt is arranged.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Receiver: suite 4 uses the staffed front desk; the annex serves suite 6.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: Dispatch asks whether all deliveries use the front desk. Limit the correction to Alder Books.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Shipment 418 names suite 4, but the route note points to the rear annex. Could you confirm which entrance receives Alder Books deliveries? I need the receiving location for this shipment, not just the building address. I'll ask dispatch to correct the note once we have that distinction clear.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Choose grammar that preserves the meaning

1. Use the lesson's language workshop, or one actual sentence from the dialogue, to explain a single grammar distinction in no more than 90 words. Show how it affects timing, certainty, responsibility or politeness.
2. Give one brief occupational exchange containing a gap and four complete options A-D. Supply enough context for exactly one answer. Keep distractors plausible; distinguish grammar errors from wording that changes the facts. Stop and wait.
3. Explain why each choice fits or fails, then ask me to read the completed exchange aloud. Do not request a draft, original written sentence or essay.
4. Repeat with three new exchanges, one at a time, moving from recognition to a more subtle meaning contrast. Do not copy the published checks. Label invented variations and do not turn uncertainty into a promise.
5. End with a short contrast table and two supported spoken turns using supplied frames. Accept accurate alternatives in oral practice; acknowledge and replace ambiguous multiple-choice items.

END PROMPT